

Research Assistant Training Manual

Everything a Research Assistant needs to work on the ABF-FST study: the study, ethics, data protection, the portal, your role, scripts, scenarios and practice exercises.

STUDY	Developing and Validating the Agribusiness Bankability Framework for Food Systems Transformation through Novel Financing Models in Zimbabwe (ABF-FST)
PRINCIPAL RESEARCHER	Happyson Saina, Doctor of Strategic Management candidate, Chinhoyi University of Technology
SUPERVISORS	Dr L. Chikazhe and Dr J. Kanyepe
FOR	Research Assistants (Contact, QUAN/Kobo QA, KII and Documentary)
SYSTEM ADDRESS	https://research.agribizframework.com
CONTACT	0773943709 · abffst.research.cut@gmail.com
VERSION	Version 1.0 · 15 September 2026

Screenshots in this document use **fictional demonstration data**. Organisation and person names, phone numbers and figures shown in them are not real study records.

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1. Welcome

Thank you for joining the ABF-FST research team. This manual goes with your three-day training. Keep it with you during fieldwork. Your **Role Guide** has the full step-by-step instructions for your screens; this manual explains the why, the standards and the skills.

How to use this manual

- Read Sections 1–4 before Day 1.
- Read the module for your role (Section 6) before Day 2.
- Complete the exercises (Section 8) during the training.
- Use the checklists (Section 9) every working day.

Who to contact

Day-to-day questions	Your Field Coordinator
Ethics, consent, data protection, anything serious	Happyson Saina (PI) — 0773943709 — abffst.research.cut@gmail.com
Account or password problems	The PI

2. The study

Developing and Validating the Agribusiness Bankability Framework for Food Systems Transformation through Novel Financing Models in Zimbabwe (ABF-FST) is a doctoral study by Happyson Saina at Chinhoyi University of Technology, supervised by Dr L. Chikazhe and Dr J. Kanyepe. It looks at how agribusinesses in Zimbabwe can become better prepared for financing and investment.

Strand	What we collect	Target
Questionnaire (quantitative)	One questionnaire from a senior person at each Main-400 organisation	400 completed
Key Informant Interviews	Interviews with experts from government, finance, development partners, associations and research	60 completed
Documentary evidence	Policies, reports, platforms and media, coded with the Document Analysis Tool	50–75 coded

Sample	400 Main organisations, each with a matched Reserve that may replace it only for an authorised reason.
Data lock	30 November 2026.
What the study never does	It never produces a score, rating or financing decision for anyone taking part, and individual answers are never shared with any lender.

Explaining the study in two minutes

"I'm calling from the ABF-FST research team at Chinhoyi University of Technology. We're studying how agribusinesses in Zimbabwe can become better prepared for finance and investment. Your organisation was selected to take part. It's voluntary, takes about 15 to 25 minutes, and it's for research only: there's no score or financing decision, and individual answers are never shared with any lender. Could I tell you how it works?"

3. Ethics and data protection

3.1 Principles you must apply

Principle	What it means for you
Voluntary participation	People may say no, stop at any time, or skip questions. Never pressure, never offer benefits, never imply consequences.
Informed consent	Before any question, the person must understand the study (Participant Information Sheet v1.3) and agree. On the portal they select I agree to take part; for assisted interviews you read the information and they agree before you start.
Separate recording consent	For KIs, recording needs its own yes. Participation consent never implies recording consent.
Confidentiality	Names and contact details are kept separately from answers and used only to manage participation. Results are reported only in combined, anonymised form.
Right to withdraw	Anyone may withdraw at any time. Stop contact and tell the Field Coordinator the same day. Answers already submitted are kept for the audit trail but never analysed.
No harm, no deception	Be honest about who we are and what the study does. Never say answers affect finance.

3.2 What respondents are told (PIS v1.3, summary)

- Who is doing the study and the CUT ethics clearance.
- The questionnaire takes around 15–25 minutes, online or with a researcher by phone or WhatsApp.
- Public information may be looked up beforehand and shown for confirmation; they may skip that step.
- Participation is voluntary; they may decline or stop at any time.
- No score, rating or financing decision; answers never shared with lenders.
- Contact details kept separately, used only for participation; results combined and anonymised.
- Questions: Happyson Saina, 0773943709, abfst.research.cut@gmail.com.

3.3 Data protection rules

The study follows Zimbabwe's Cyber and Data Protection Act and the study's data protection protocol.

- Treat everything in the portal as **confidential research data**. Do not screenshot, copy, print or forward names, phone numbers, email addresses or answers except as your role requires.
- Never share your username or password, and never sign in for someone else.
- Use the respondent's contact details **only** to manage their participation in this study (invitations, reminders, appointments).
- Never tell a respondent, lender or anyone else that answers affect financing. The study generates **no score, rating or financing decision**.
- If a respondent asks to withdraw, stop contacting them and tell the Field Coordinator or PI the same day so the withdrawal is recorded.

- Report a lost device, a suspected account compromise, or data sent to the wrong person to the PI immediately.

3.4 Your devices

- Use a screen lock on every device you use for the study, and never leave the portal open and unattended.
- Send WhatsApp messages only from the study number (WhatsApp Business on the study phone or WhatsApp Web linked to it). Never from your personal WhatsApp.
- Don't save respondents to your personal contacts, and don't add them to groups.
- Don't download PDFs or exports to personal devices or cloud folders.
- Report a lost or stolen device to the PI immediately.

3.5 Conduct

- Be polite, patient and professional, in the language the respondent prefers.
- Contact people during normal working hours, or at the times they ask for, as agreed with your Field Coordinator.
- Never promise anything the study cannot give.
- Record the truth: never mark something as sent, done or agreed if it wasn't.
- Escalate anything unusual — a complaint, a threat, a data problem — to the Field Coordinator or PI the same day.

4. The portal and the forms

Signing in

1. Open <https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login> in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari), on a computer, tablet or phone.
2. Type your **Username** and **Password**, then select **Sign in**.

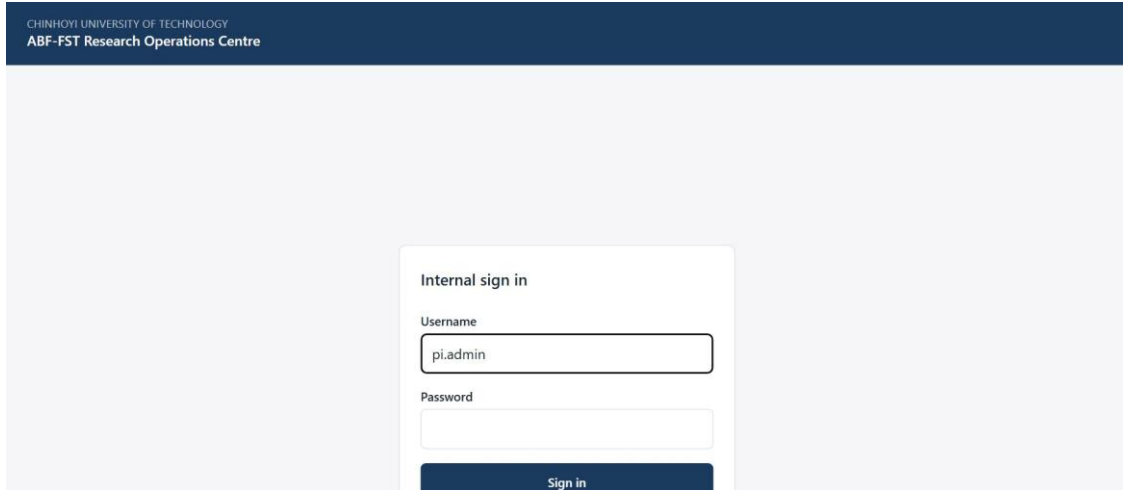
The screenshot shows a web browser window with a dark blue header bar. The header contains the text 'CHINHOMI UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY' and 'ABF-FST Research Operations Centre' in white. Below the header is a light gray background. In the center, there is a white box titled 'Internal sign in'. Inside this box, there are two input fields: 'Username' with the text 'pi.admin' and 'Password'. Below the password field is a dark blue button with the text 'Sign in' in white.

Figure 1. The sign-in screen for all internal staff.

3. You arrive on your start screen: **your role's start screen**. The bar across the top lists only the screens your role (your role) can open.

Accounts

There is no self-registration. The PI / System Admin creates every account and sets its role. Ask the PI if you need an account, a different role, or a password reset.

Finding your way around

- The **top bar** shows your username and role, and the screens you can use. It is not a full menu with some items greyed out: anything absent is simply not part of your role.
- Most screens have a **← Back to ...** link at the top that returns you to the screen you came from.
- Registers show **20 rows per page**. Use **Previous** and **Next** at the foot of the list, and the **Search** box above it.
- **Change password** (top right) lets you set a new password at any time. Choose a long password you do not use anywhere else.
- **Sign out** (top right) ends your session. Always sign out on a shared or public computer.
- If you are inactive for a while you may be asked to sign in again. This protects research data on unattended devices.

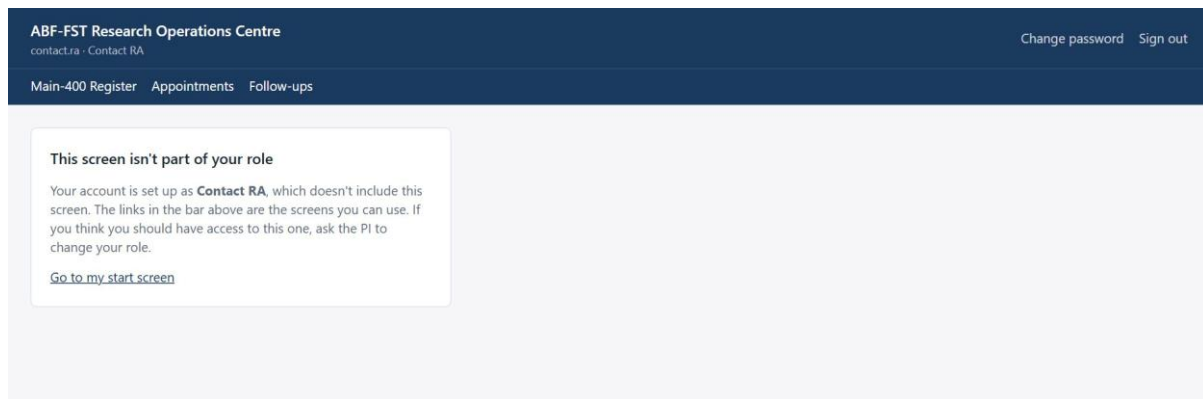


Figure 2. Opening a screen outside your role (for example from an old bookmark) shows this card instead of the screen.

Roles

Role	Screens	Starts on
PI / System Admin	All 19 screens, including the Audit Log and every export	Executive Dashboard
Field / Digital Coordinator	18 screens — everything except the Audit Log. No full operational export and no KoboToolbox data download	Executive Dashboard
Contact RA	Main-400 Register, Appointments, Follow-ups — only the cases assigned to you	Main-400 Register
QUAN/Kobo QA RA	QA Dashboard, Form PDFs (questionnaire), QA Queue, QA Exceptions	QA Dashboard
KII RA	KII/Doc Dashboard, Form PDFs (KII Guide), KII Register	KII/Doc Dashboard
Documentary RA	KII/Doc Dashboard, Form PDFs (Document Analysis Tool), Documents	KII/Doc Dashboard
Data Analyst	Executive, Sampling, Reports, Contact and KII/Doc dashboards, Cost, Export (de-identified only). Read-only	Executive Dashboard
Supervisor (read-only)	17 screens — everything except the Audit Log and Export. Read-only	Executive Dashboard

Case statuses you will see

Code	Status	Meaning
S00	Selected Main	The case is in the Main-400 sample. Starting point for every Main case.
S01	Verification required	The organisation's details are being checked.
S02	Organisation verified	The organisation exists, is active and is the right one.
S03	Eligible respondent identified	A knowledgeable senior person has been identified. Ready to invite.
S04	Invitation prepared	Optional manual step before sending.
S05	Invitation sent	Set automatically when an invitation is issued.
S06	Invitation opened	Set automatically when the respondent opens the link.
S07	Survey started	Set automatically when the respondent opens the questionnaire.

Code	Status	Meaning
S08	Survey submitted	Set automatically when the questionnaire arrives from KoboToolbox.
S09	QA query	Set automatically when a QA reviewer re-queries the submission.
S10	QA passed	Set automatically when a QA reviewer accepts the submission.
S11	Completed	Final: the case is finished.
S12	Refused	Drop state: the organisation declined or withdrew.
S13	Nonresponse	Drop state: no response after every approved reminder was sent.
S14	Ineligible	Drop state: the organisation or respondent does not qualify.
S15	Duplicate / inactive	Drop state: duplicate record or organisation no longer operating.
S16	Reserve eligible for activation	The matched Reserve may now be activated to replace this case.

The KoboToolbox forms

Form	Used by	Linked by
Main Study Questionnaire	Respondents; Contact RAs in assisted interviews	Opened from the portal link, which carries the Sample ID
Main Study KII Guide	KII RAs	KII ID
Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool	Documentary RAs	DOC ID

Always start the questionnaire from the portal

A questionnaire opened any other way (for example from a saved KoboToolbox link) is not matched to a case and is set aside.

5. Communication scripts

5.1 First phone call

1. "Good morning. My name is [name], from the ABF-FST research team at Chinhoyi University of Technology. May I speak to [name / the managing director]?"
2. Explain the study in two minutes (Section 2).
3. "Are you the best person to answer for [organisation] — for example the owner, managing director, or head of finance or operations?" If not, ask who is and when to reach them.
4. "May I send you a personal link by WhatsApp or email? You can complete it yourself, or I can go through it with you by phone."
5. Confirm their number or email, thank them, and log the attempt.

5.2 If they are busy

"I understand. When would be a better time? I can call back, or send the link so you can do it when it suits you." Log the outcome RESCHEDULED with the agreed time.

5.3 Voicemail or no answer

Keep it short: "Good day, this is [name] from the ABF-FST research team at Chinhoyi University of Technology, about a short university study your organisation was selected for. I'll try again, or you can call 0773943709." Log NO_ANSWER.

5.4 Common questions

They ask	You say
"How did you get my number?"	"Your organisation was selected from the study's sampling register of agribusinesses in Zimbabwe." If they want more detail, give them the PI's contact details.
"How long will it take?"	"About 15 to 25 minutes."
"Is it confidential?"	"Yes. Answers are used only for research and reported only in combined, anonymised form."
"Will this affect our finance?"	"No. The study produces no score, rating or financing decision, and answers are never shared with any lender."
"What do we get?"	"It's voluntary academic research. Taking part doesn't lead to finance, investment or any commercial benefit; the findings aim to improve how agribusiness financing works in Zimbabwe."
"Can I stop halfway?"	"Yes, at any time."

5.5 Refusals and withdrawals

"Thank you for letting me know, and for your time. We won't contact you again about the study." Then log REFUSED with their words and tell the Field Coordinator the same day. Never argue or ask twice.

6. Role modules

Read the module for your role. The steps are the same as in your Role Guide.

Module A — Contact RA

Invitations and reminders need a phone or WhatsApp number. Record the eligible person as soon as they are identified.

1. Open the case (**Main-400 Register → View**) and find **Respondents and contact details**.
2. Select **Add a person**. Enter **Full name**, **Phone**, **WhatsApp number**, **Email**, and a **Gatekeeper name** and **Gatekeeper contact** if you reach the person through a PA or receptionist.

Respondents and contact details

Full name Phone

WhatsApp number Email

Gatekeeper name Gatekeeper contact

Role Eligibility

Tendai Demo-Moyo
 CEO/MD - Eligible
 Phone +263 77 000 1000 · WhatsApp +263 77 000 1000 · respondent0@example.org

Figure 3. Adding a person to a case.

3. Choose their **role** and the eligibility decision: **Eligible (I screened them)**, **Not eligible**, or **Not yet screened**.
4. Select **Save person**. To correct details later, select **Edit** beside the person, change the fields, then **Save changes**.
5. Write WhatsApp numbers in international form, e.g. **+263 77 123 4567**, so the WhatsApp buttons open the right chat.

Who is eligible?

Owner or founder, CEO or managing director, finance/credit/risk, operations, strategy/business development, supply chain/commercial, or another senior manager who can answer for the organisation. Anyone else should nominate the right person.

Sending an invitation

1. Open the case. Check the status is **S03** and a respondent with a number is recorded.
2. In **Invitations**, leave **Channel** as **WHATSAPP** (or choose EMAIL, SMS, PRINTED_CODE or QR to record how it was delivered) and **Wave** as **1**. Select **Send invitation**.

Invitations

Channel: WHATSAPP Wave: 1 **Send new invitation (replaces current)**

Wave	Channel	Status	Issued	Actions
1	WHATSAPP	SENT	9/15/2026	Revoke

Figure 4. Invitations panel before sending, with the history of earlier invitations.

- The personal link and 8-character manual code appear **once**, with the invitation already written for each channel. Choose **WhatsApp message**, **SMS message** or **Email message** to see exactly what will be sent: the personal link, its expiry date, the manual code and the study contact line.

Invitations

Invitation link (shown once -- send it now)

http://localhost:3000/r/WPIS_gIH6iWn3HQArJwKBRd0xedUMjR-nUK2IRHHk

Manual code (for phone-assisted administration): 34BOJDIN - expires 9/30/2026

WhatsApp message SMS message Email message

Hello, You are invited to take part in the ABF-FST research study at Chinhoyi University of Technology on agribusiness financing in Zimbabwe. Taking part is voluntary.

Your personal link: http://localhost:3000/r/WPIS_gIH6iWn3HQArJwKBRd0xedUMjR-nUK2IRHHk
(valid until 30 September 2026)

Prefer to answer by phone? Reply to this message and quote code 34BOJDIN.

Questions: Happyson Saina, 0773943709, abfst.research.cut@gmail.com

Send via WhatsApp **Copy message**

Opens the chat with Tendai Demo-Moyo (+263770001000). Send it from the study WhatsApp number.
After sending, log it under Contact timeline.

Figure 5. The link, manual code and ready-written messages are shown once, with a send button for each channel.

- Send it on the channel that suits the respondent:
 - Send via WhatsApp** opens that respondent's chat (their WhatsApp number, or phone number if none) with the message ready. Check you are on the study WhatsApp number, then press Send.
 - Send by SMS** opens the phone's messages app addressed to the respondent, with the shorter SMS message. Use it on a phone.
 - Email from study address** sends the email from abfst.research.cut@gmail.com to the respondent's email on file; replies go to the study inbox. The email is recorded in the audit log.
 - Open in email app** opens the same email in your own mail program, if you need to add something first.
 - Copy message** copies the message shown, for any other channel.
- If a button says no number or email is on file, add it under **Respondents and contact details**, then send a new invitation.
- The case moves to **S05 Invitation sent** automatically. Log the attempt in **Contact timeline** (see Logging a contact attempt).

The link is shown only once

The portal stores only a scrambled fingerprint of the link, so nobody can display it again. If you close the page before sending, select **Send new invitation (replaces current)**: this issues a fresh link and the old one stops working immediately.

Links are valid for **14 days**. Each link belongs to one organisation; never forward one respondent's link to another organisation.

Revoking an invitation

In the invitation history, select **Revoke** on an open invitation (for example, if it was sent to the wrong number). The link stops working at once. Issue a new one if the case should still be invited.

Logging a contact attempt

Record **every** attempt, successful or not. The Contact Dashboard, Reports and any later replacement decision rely on it.

1. On the case page, scroll to **Contact timeline** → **Log a contact attempt**.

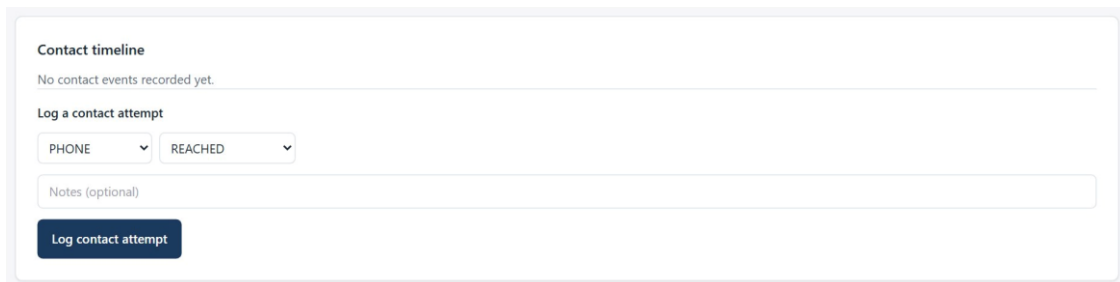
The screenshot shows a web interface for logging a contact attempt. At the top, it says 'Contact timeline' and 'No contact events recorded yet.' Below this is a section titled 'Log a contact attempt'. It contains two dropdown menus: the first is labeled 'PHONE' and the second is labeled 'REACHED'. Below these is a text input field with the placeholder 'Notes (optional)'. At the bottom of the form is a dark blue button labeled 'Log contact attempt'.

Figure 6. Contact timeline and the form for logging an attempt.

2. Choose the **channel** (WHATSAPP, EMAIL, PHONE, SMS, FACE_TO_FACE) and the **outcome** (REACHED, NO_ANSWER, WRONG_NUMBER, REFUSED, RESCHEDULED, COMPLETED).
3. Add a short, factual note (optional), e.g. "PA says MD travelling; call back Thursday". Do not record opinions about the person.
4. Select **Log contact attempt**. The entry appears at the top of the timeline with the date and time.

Sending follow-up reminders

Approved reminders fall due on **Day 2** and **Day 7** after an invitation for respondents who have not yet submitted. Until automatic WhatsApp sending is connected, a person sends each one.

1. Select **Follow-ups**. Each card shows the case, organisation, which reminder is due, when the invitation went out, the respondent and their number, and the exact approved message.

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
contactLra · Contact RA

Change password Sign out

Main-400 Register Appointments Follow-ups

← Back to Main-400 Register

Follow-ups due

Approved reminders for invited cases that haven't responded yet. Open WhatsApp, send the message, then mark it sent.

SID-2026-000039 S05

Silver Stream Livestock Traders
Day 7 final routine attempt - invited 9/7/2026 - Munashe Demo-Sibanda - no number on file

Hello, this is a final reminder about the ABF-FST research study invitation. If you would still like to take part, please use the link you were sent. Thank you.

Open WhatsApp (choose contact) Mark as sent

SID-2026-000029 S05

Red Earth Dairy Processors
Day 7 final routine attempt - invited 9/8/2026 - Nokuthula Demo-Zvobgo - no number on file

Hello, this is a final reminder about the ABF-FST research study invitation. If you would still like to take part, please use the link you were sent. Thank you.

Open WhatsApp (choose contact) Mark as sent

SID-2026-000045 S06

Highveld Meadow Agro-Dealers
Day 2 reminder - invited 9/11/2026 - Farai Demo-Zvobgo - +263 77 000 1022

Hello, this is a reminder about the ABF-FST research study invitation sent to your organisation. Please use the link you were sent to take part, or reply here if you have questions.

Figure 7. Follow-ups due. Contact RAs see only their own cases.

2. Select **Open in WhatsApp**. WhatsApp opens with the message ready for that number; send it. If the card says **no number on file**, the button reads **Open WhatsApp (choose contact)** — pick the chat yourself, and add the number to the case afterwards.
3. Come back and select **Mark as sent**. The card disappears and the reminder is recorded under your name.

Mark as sent only after sending

A case can become **S13 Nonresponse** (and be replaced by its Reserve) only after every reminder has been recorded as sent. Marking a reminder you did not send could lead to an organisation being replaced without being contacted.

Managing appointments

1. Select **Appointments**. Each row shows the case (Sample ID and organisation) or KII, the requested time, the mode (PHONE, WHATSAPP_VOICE, ZOOM, ...) and the status.

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
contactLra · Contact RA

Change password Sign out

Main-400 Register Appointments Follow-ups

← Back to Main-400 Register

Appointment Queue

All statuses ▾

Case / informant	Scheduled for	Mode	Status	Actions
SID-2026-000045 Highveld Meadow Agro-Dealers	9/13/2026, 7:15:00 PM	PHONE	COMPLETED	No further action
SID-2026-000051 Baobab Ridge Poultry Farmers Association	9/14/2026, 7:15:00 PM	FACE_TO_FACE	MISSED	No further action
SID-2026-000025 Granite Kopje Agro-Dealers	9/16/2026, 9:15:00 PM	PHONE	REQUESTED	CONFIRMED CANCELLED
SID-2026-000029 Red Earth Dairy Processors	9/18/2026, 12:15:00 AM	WHATSAPP_VOICE	CONFIRMED	COMPLETED MISSED CANCELLED
SID-2026-000087 Silver Stream Fresh Produce Market	9/18/2026, 10:00:00 AM	PHONE	REQUESTED	CONFIRMED CANCELLED
SID-2026-000041 Acacia Downs Growers Cooperative	9/18/2026, 7:15:00 PM	ZOOM	REQUESTED	CONFIRMED CANCELLED

Figure 8. Appointment Queue.

2. Use **Filter by status** to show, for example, only **REQUESTED** appointments.
3. Contact the respondent to confirm, then select **CONFIRMED**.
4. After the session select **COMPLETED**, or **MISSED** if they did not attend, or **CANCELLED**. Only valid next steps are shown; a finished appointment shows **No further action**.

Phone, WhatsApp-call or face-to-face administration

When the respondent prefers help, the researcher completes the questionnaire with them. The respondent must still hear the participant information and agree before any question is asked.

1. Agree a time. If the respondent booked through the portal, it is in **Appointments**.
2. At the start of the call, confirm the organisation and the person's role, read or summarise the Participant Information Sheet (v1.3) and ask for consent. Stop if they decline.
3. Open the respondent's personal invitation link on your device and go through the portal screens with them (organisation, role, information, consent), choosing the answers they give you.
4. Open the questionnaire from the portal so the case identifiers travel with the form, and complete it with the respondent. Never start the KoboToolbox form from a bookmark: a submission without the portal's link is set aside and not matched.
5. After submitting, log the contact attempt with outcome **COMPLETED**, and mark the appointment **COMPLETED**.

Code	Mode	What happens
01	Web self-administration	The respondent completes the questionnaire alone from the link.
02	WhatsApp link, self-completion	The link is sent by WhatsApp; the respondent completes it alone.
03	Telephone, interviewer-administered	A researcher calls and completes the form while the respondent answers.
04	WhatsApp call, interviewer-assisted	As 03, over a WhatsApp voice or video call.
05	Video call, interviewer-assisted	As 03, over Teams, Zoom or Google Meet.
06	Face to face	In person; the researcher operates the device.

Module B — QUAN/Kobo QA RA

Reviewing questionnaires in the QA Queue

1. Select **QA Queue**. Each submission shows the Sample ID, when it was submitted, the administration mode, the completion time in minutes and its QA status (PENDING or QUERY).

Figure 9. QUAN QA Queue with the KoboToolbox sync panel.

- Open the completed form to check the answers: **Form PDFs → Download PDF**, or the **Completed questionnaire** panel on the case page.
- Check it against the QA rules (table below) and any open QA exception for that case.
- Write a **Note (required)** explaining your decision.
- Select **Accept** (moves the case to S10 QA passed), **Re-query** (S09 QA query — follow up with the respondent or the RA who administered it) or **Reject** (not usable).

Rule	Setting	Effect
Required answers missing	65 required fields from the live questionnaire	Hard stop: raises an exception; cannot pass without a human decision and note.
Too quick	Completed in under 5 minutes (300 s)	Soft flag for review.
Too slow	Completed in over 90 minutes (5400 s)	Soft flag for review.
Possible duplicate	Another submission for the same organisation within 24 hours	Soft flag for review.

Nothing passes automatically

Even a submission with no flags needs a person to select Accept. Every decision and its note is audited.

Pulling new submissions now

Submissions arrive within seconds (KoboToolbox notifies the portal) and a full check runs every 15 minutes between 06:00 and 22:00 and hourly overnight. To check immediately, select **Sync now** in **KoboToolbox sync**; the panel shows the last run, how many were pulled and how many were new or updated. An edited submission returns to the queue for review.

Working QA exceptions

1. Select **QA Exceptions**. Each card shows the rule that fired (for example `hard_stop_missing_required_fields` or `min_plausible_duration_seconds`), the Sample ID, when it was raised and its status. Oldest first.

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
qa.ra - QUAN/Kobo QA RA

QA Dashboard Form PDFs QA Queue QA Exceptions

Change password Sign out

← Back to QA Queue

QA Exception Queue ☐ Only mine ☐ Show closed

Automated QA flags awaiting someone. Oldest first.

OPEN ON THIS PAGE
1

IN PROGRESS
2

OLDEST HERE
today

min_plausible_duration_seconds Open
QUAN submission SID-2826-000057 - raised 9/15/2026

Unassigned

What was done about it? (required to close)

Resolved Not a real problem

A note is required before closing — a closure nobody explained looks the same as one nobody looked at.

hard_stop_missing_required_fields In progress
QUAN submission SID-2826-000065 - raised 9/15/2026

qa.ra with qa.ra

Figure 10. QA Exception Queue.

2. Tick **Only mine** to see exceptions assigned to you; tick **Show closed** to include resolved ones.
3. Use **Assign to** to take ownership (or give it to a colleague). The status becomes **In progress**.
4. Investigate: open the form PDF, check the case timeline, contact the respondent if needed.
5. Type **What was done about it?** and select **Resolved**, or **Not a real problem** if the flag was a false alarm. A note is always required.

Writing good QA notes

- Say what you checked and what you found: "Duration 3 min; Sections 4–6 all answered 3; re-queried with the RA."
- For Accept: "All required answers present; 28 min plausible; no duplicate."
- For Re-query: say exactly what must be confirmed or completed.
- Never comment on the person, only on the data.

Module C — KII RA

Creating a KII record

1. Select **KII Register** → **New KII record**.

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kura · KII RA

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KII/Doc Dashboard Form PDFs KII Register

← Back to KII Register

New KII Record

Stakeholder category

Participant name

Participant role

Preferred mode
PHONE

Create KII record

Figure 11. New KII Record.

2. Enter **Stakeholder category**, **Participant name**, **Participant role** and **Preferred mode**, then select **Create KII record**. The KII ID (e.g. KII-0026) is generated.

Taking a KII from invitation to coded transcript

1. In **KII Register**, select **Manage** on the record.

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KII Register

Search KII ID, name or role

New KII record

KII ID	Stakeholder category	Status	Transcript	Coding	
KII-0001	Government / regulator	COMPLETED	VERIFIED	COMPLETE	Manage
KII-0002	Development finance institution	COMPLETED	IN_PROGRESS	IN_PROGRESS	Manage
KII-0003	Commercial bank	COMPLETED	ANONYMISED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0004	Agribusiness association	COMPLETED	VERIFIED	COMPLETE	Manage
KII-0005	Donor / NGO	COMPLETED	IN_PROGRESS	IN_PROGRESS	Manage
KII-0006	Academic expert	COMPLETED	ANONYMISED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0007	Government / regulator	COMPLETED	VERIFIED	COMPLETE	Manage
KII-0008	Development finance institution	COMPLETED	IN_PROGRESS	IN_PROGRESS	Manage
KII-0009	Commercial bank	SCHEDULED	NOT_STARTED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0010	Agribusiness association	SCHEDULED	NOT_STARTED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0011	Donor / NGO	SCHEDULED	NOT_STARTED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0012	Academic expert	SCHEDULED	NOT_STARTED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0013	Government / regulator	SCHEDULED	NOT_STARTED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0014	Development finance institution	INVITED	NOT_STARTED	NOT_STARTED	Manage

Figure 12. KII Register.

2. Move the **Status** as things happen: PROSPECT → INVITED → SCHEDULED → COMPLETED, or DECLINED / NO_SHOW. Only valid next statuses are shown; NO_SHOW can be rescheduled.

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← Back to KII Register

Simba Demo-Moyo
KII-0009 · Commercial bank · Policy Analyst

Status: SCHEDULED

COMPLETED NO_SHOW DECLINED

☐ Recording made (requires separate recording consent)

Consent

Participation and recording consent are always captured separately -- recording consent is never inferred from participation consent.

Record participation consent Participation: Not recorded

Record recording consent Recording: Not recorded

Transcript: NOT_STARTED

NOT_STARTED IN_PROGRESS VERIFIED ANONYMISED

Coding: NOT_STARTED

NOT_STARTED IN_PROGRESS COMPLETE

Completed KII form (KoboToolbox)

No completed form in KoboToolbox for KII-0009 yet.

Figure 13. KII record: status, consent, transcript and coding.

- Before the interview starts, select **Record participation consent**. If the interview will be recorded, also select **Record recording consent** — the two are always separate.
- When marking **COMPLETED**, tick **Recording made** only if a recording exists. The portal refuses a recorded completion without recording consent.
- Advance **Transcript** (NOT_STARTED → IN_PROGRESS → VERIFIED → ANONYMISED) and **Coding** (NOT_STARTED → IN_PROGRESS → COMPLETE) as the work progresses.
- Complete the **KII Guide** form in KoboToolbox using the KII ID. The **Completed KII form (KoboToolbox)** panel then links to its PDF.

Running the interview

- Standard KII: mandatory core (Part B), one or two role-triggered modules (Part C), then closing (Part E). 30–45 minutes.
- Executive Short Form: only for genuinely time-constrained senior people. Ask K1, K2, K3, K7 and K9, one short probe each, 12–15 minutes, and record that the short form was used.
- Don't ask every specialist module, and never disguise a long interview as an executive one.
- If recording is declined, take contemporaneous notes only with permission and record that no audio exists.
- A person who declines consent is recorded in the portal's KII register (the KoboToolbox form can't record a decline).

Module D — Documentary RA

Adding a document

- Select **Documents → New document**.

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documents.ra · Documentary RA

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KII/Doc Dashboard Form PDFs Documents

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New Documentary Evidence Record

Title

Author / speaker

Source URL / reference

Document type
OFFICIAL

Geographic scope

Evidence extract

Figure 14. New Documentary Evidence Record.

- Enter **Title**, **Author / speaker**, **Source URL / reference**, **Document type** (OFFICIAL, SECONDARY or PLATFORM), **Geographic scope** and an **Evidence extract**, then select **Create document record**. The document ID (e.g. DOC-0025) is generated.

Assessing and including a document

- In **Documents**, select **Manage** on the record.

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Documentary Evidence Corpus

Search title, ID or author [New document](#)

Document ID	Title	Type	Authenticity	QA status	
DOC-0001	Agricultural Finance Strategy 2025–2030 (demo 1)	OFFICIAL	VERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0002	Warehouse Receipt System Annual Report (demo 2)	SECONDARY	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0003	Contract Farming Guidelines (demo 3)	PLATFORM	UNVERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0004	Agro-dealer Credit Survey (demo 4)	OFFICIAL	DISPUTED	EXCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0005	Value Chain Finance Review: Horticulture (demo 5)	SECONDARY	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0006	Mobile Money Adoption among Smallholders (demo 6)	PLATFORM	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0007	Crop Insurance Market Assessment (demo 7)	OFFICIAL	UNVERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0008	Tobacco Contract Finance Statement (demo 8)	SECONDARY	DISPUTED	EXCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0009	Dairy Sector Investment Brief (demo 9)	PLATFORM	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0010	Bank Lending to Agriculture Bulletin (demo 10)	OFFICIAL	VERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0011	Cooperative Governance Toolkit (demo 11)	SECONDARY	UNVERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0012	Blended Finance Case Study (demo 12)	PLATFORM	DISPUTED	EXCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0013	Agricultural Finance Strategy 2025–2030 (demo 13)	OFFICIAL	VERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0014	Warehouse Receipt System Annual Report (demo 14)	SECONDARY	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage

Figure 15. Documentary Evidence Corpus.

- Assess authenticity: select **Mark verified** or **Mark disputed**.

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documents.ra - Documentary RA

Change password Sign out

KI/Doc Dashboard Form PDFs Documents

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Contract Farming Guidelines (demo 3)
DOC-0003 > PLATFORM

Authenticity: UNVERIFIED

Mark verified Mark disputed

QA status: PENDING

Include Exclude

Cannot be included until authenticity is assessed.

Interpretive memo (dispute reasons, notes)

Save memo

Completed coding form (KoboToolbox)

No completed form in KoboToolbox for DOC-0003 yet.

Figure 16. Document record: authenticity, QA status, memo and coding form.

3. Set the QA status: **Include** or **Exclude**. A document cannot be included until authenticity has been assessed.
4. Write the **Interpretive memo** (dispute reasons, interpretation notes) and select **Save memo**.
5. Code the document in the **Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool** in KoboToolbox using the DOC ID; its PDF then appears on the record.

Evidence standards

- Golden rule: never code an opinion from memory. Every claim needs a source, a date or year, the evidence and a locator someone else can follow.
- Official sources: check them on the issuer's own site or registry.
- Platform and media sources: record the URL, the visible date and the date you accessed it; corroborate elsewhere.
- Rated Exclude in Section B: Sections C–L are skipped; the provenance and screening you recorded are kept for the audit trail.
- Mark Disputed when authorship, date or content can't be confirmed, and explain why in the memo.

7. Scenarios

Think about each before Day 3. The suggested answer is what good practice looks like.

Scenario	Situation	Good practice
1. The gatekeeper	A receptionist says the MD is busy and asks what this is about.	Explain briefly (university study, voluntary, 15–25 minutes); ask for the best person and a good time; record them as gatekeeper; log RESCHEDULED.
2. "Will this affect our loan?"	The finance manager worries answers reach the bank.	No score, rating or financing decision; answers never shared with any lender; results only reported combined and anonymised.
3. Wrong person	A junior officer received the link and wants to fill it in.	Thank them; only senior, knowledgeable roles take part; ask who that is; record and invite that person instead.
4. Refusal	The owner says they are not interested.	Thank them, don't persuade; log REFUSED with their words; tell the Field Coordinator the same day.
5. Withdrawal after submitting	A respondent who completed the questionnaire asks for their answers not to be used.	Stop contact; tell the Field Coordinator, who records the withdrawal; their answers are kept for the audit trail but never analysed.
6. Expired link	A respondent tries a link from three weeks ago.	Links last 14 days. Check the invitation history and send a new invitation (it replaces the old one).
7. Phone interview	A respondent prefers to answer by phone now.	Confirm organisation and role, read the information, get consent, then open their link and complete it with them (mode 03). Log COMPLETED.
8. KII recording	An informant agrees to the interview but not to recording.	Record participation consent only; take notes; do not tick Recording made; the portal refuses a recorded completion without recording consent.
9. QA: 3-minute questionnaire	A submission is flagged as too quick.	Open the PDF; look for straight-lining and blanks; Re-query with a specific note, or Accept only if the answers are credible — and say why.
10. Undated web source	A useful platform page has no visible date.	Record the URL and the date accessed; look for corroboration; mark Disputed if authorship or date can't be confirmed, with reasons in the memo.

8. Practice exercises

Complete these on the practice site during training. Never on the live portal.

Exercise 1 — Getting around (all RAs)

1. Sign in with your practice account and change your password.
2. List the screens in your top bar and write one sentence on what each is for.
3. Open a screen that isn't yours from a link your facilitator gives you. What do you see?
4. Sign out.

Exercise 2 — A complete contact (Contact RAs)

1. Open the practice case your facilitator assigns you.
2. Add the respondent your facilitator describes, with a correctly formatted WhatsApp number (your own phone).
3. Send the invitation by WhatsApp from the demo study number and log the attempt.
4. On your phone, open the link and go as far as the consent screen. Which screens did you see?
5. Back in the portal, find the change of status. What is it now, and why?

Exercise 3 — QA decisions (QA RAs)

1. Open the practice QA Queue. Choose the three oldest submissions.
2. For each, open the PDF and decide Accept, Re-query or Reject. Write your note.
3. Swap notes with a partner. Could they understand your reasoning without asking you?
4. Take one practice exception, assign it to yourself, and close it with a note.

Exercise 4 — A KII record (KII RAs)

1. Create a practice KII record for a fictional informant.
2. Move it to SCHEDULED; record participation consent only.
3. Try to mark it COMPLETED with Recording made ticked. What happens, and why?
4. Complete it correctly and advance the transcript to IN_PROGRESS.

Exercise 5 — A document (Documentary RAs)

1. Add a practice document from a public web page your facilitator names.
2. Try to Include it straight away. What happens?
3. Assess authenticity, include or exclude it, and write a three-sentence memo.

9. Daily checklists

Start of the day

- Sign in on a locked, private device; check the study WhatsApp is the account open.
- Contact RAs: Follow-ups (send and mark every due reminder), Appointments for today.
- QA RAs: QA Dashboard, oldest exceptions, then the queue.
- KII RAs: today's scheduled interviews and consent forms ready.
- Documentary RAs: documents waiting for assessment.

End of the day

- Every call, message and decision is recorded in the portal.
- Refusals, withdrawals, complaints and anything unusual reported to the Field Coordinator.
- No personal data left on the device outside the portal; signed out.

Troubleshooting

Situation	Likely cause	What to do
"This screen isn't part of your role"	The screen belongs to another role (often an old bookmark or shared link).	Select Go to my start screen. If you need that screen, ask the PI about your role.
"Too many sign-in attempts from this network"	Sign-in is rate-limited per network; an office shares one address.	Wait a minute and try again. A wrong password says so explicitly.
A register shows fewer rows than expected	Registers show 20 rows per page; a Contact RA sees only assigned cases.	Use Next, or search. Ask the Field Coordinator to assign the case.
A button is greyed out	A required step is missing (a note, an authenticity decision, a selection).	Read the message beside the button; complete the missing step first.
"KoboToolbox couldn't be reached"	KoboToolbox is slow or the connection token has changed.	Try again in a few minutes. If it persists, tell the PI.
A page keeps loading	A slow or dropped connection.	Refresh the page. Your saved work is not lost; unsaved typing may be.

10. Glossary

Term	Meaning
ABF-FST	Agribusiness Bankability Framework for Food Systems Transformation — the doctoral study this portal supports.
Main-400 / Reserve-400	The 400 selected organisations and their 400 locked, matched replacements.
Master ID	System-generated organisation identifier, e.g. MID-HA-000001 (province code + sequence).
Sample ID	System-generated case identifier, e.g. SID-2026-000001. Never typed by hand, never reused.
Stratum	The sampling cell: Province × Actor family × Size class.
Case	One organisation's place in the sample (a Sample ID).
Workflow status	Where a Main case is, from S00 Selected to S11 Completed, or a drop state (S12–S15).
Invitation	A personal link (valid 14 days) plus an 8-character manual code, issued per case.
Eligibility	The respondent's confirmation that they hold a senior, knowledgeable role.
Consent	The respondent's recorded agreement to take part (participation consent). KII recording consent is separate.
PIS	Participant Information Sheet, currently version 1.3.
PROIT	Pre-Interview Respondent & Organisation Intelligence and Verification Tool: background facts found before contact, confirmed by the respondent.
KoboToolbox	The external data-collection service that hosts the three study forms.
Submission	One completed KoboToolbox form.
QA	Quality assurance: automated checks plus a human decision on every questionnaire.
QA exception	An automated flag raised by a QA rule, worked and closed by a person.
KII	Key Informant Interview (target 60 completed).
Documentary evidence	Documents, digital platform and media sources analysed (target 50–75).
Administration mode	How the questionnaire was completed (codes 01–06).
Follow-up	An approved reminder due to be sent to an invited respondent (Day 2, Day 7).
Withdrawal	A participant's request to stop taking part, recorded once in the portal.
Audit log	The permanent record of every sensitive action and who took it.
Data lock	30 November 2026 — the date fieldwork data is frozen for analysis.

11. Confidentiality and conduct declaration

I have completed the ABF-FST Research Assistant training and I understand and agree that:

1. I will treat all study information, including names, contact details and answers, as confidential, during and after my work on the study.
2. I will use personal information only to carry out my study role, and only through the approved systems (the portal, KoboToolbox and the study WhatsApp number).
3. I will not copy, photograph, download to personal devices, share or publish study information except as my role requires.
4. I will obtain informed consent before collecting any data, respect every refusal and withdrawal, and never pressure anyone to take part.
5. I will never tell anyone that taking part or their answers affect financing.
6. I will keep my account details private, and report any lost device, suspected breach or mistake to the PI immediately.
7. I understand that my actions in the portal are recorded, and that breaching this declaration may end my role on the study.

Full name	
Role	
Signature	
Date	
Witnessed by (PI / Field Coordinator)	